



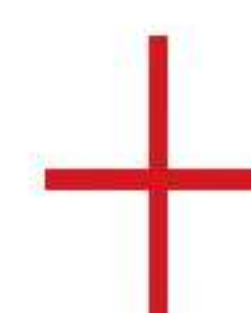
Tough comeback: Rohit Sharma's return to the Ranji Trophy after nearly a decade didn't turn out as memorable as he might have hoped. PTI

to, as was seen in the recent Sydney Test [between India and Australia] when rushes of blood caused some silly-looking dismissals. A bit of common sense and patience, rather than a fatalistic approach, could have gotten another 50 runs, and that could well have been the difference to the result of the match and the series.

The BCCI and the coach's insistence on the Indian players playing in the Ranji Trophy meant that most of the players who were on the disastrous tour of Australia turned up for their State teams in the Ranji Trophy. Whether their hearts were in it or they did that only to ensure they were not stripped of their BCCI contracts, like Ishan Kishan and Shreyas Iyer were, after missing out on the Ranji Trophy games last year, is known only to them. Rohit Sharma and Yashasvi Jaiswal's participation meant that Ayush Mhatre, who had got a couple of hundreds and some fifties, had to be

left out of the Mumbai side. Hopefully, the youngster would have spent some time with both these players and picked their brains about adding to his batting ability.

It would be interesting to see if K.L. Rahul, Mohd. Siraj, and Virat Kohli, who didn't play in last week's round of Ranji Trophy matches, will play the next round. More interesting would be what action the BCCI takes if they don't play. Were they injured? Getting a medical certificate for an 'injury' is child's play, and if they are injured, did they go to the NCA for treatment and recovery, as Nitish Reddy was sent the moment he had that side strain? Isn't that the practice for the BCCI-contracted players, that as soon as there's an injury, they have to report to the NCA, and only after the BCCI experts there certify them as fit can they resume playing for India? For all we know, these players might have opted out of the earlier games for non-injury reasons. We shall soon find out.



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